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Postal Manual Vol VIII

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official government sources or gazettes for the most reliable and authoritative information.*

Postal Manual Volume VIII : Inspection & Administrative Standards

Part 1: Inspection Protocols and Office Management

Rule 2: Inspection of Stock Depots

The Head of a Circle or the Director Postal Services is mandated to carry out the annual inspection of the Stock Depot **once a year**. During this inspection, the physical verification of all articles of stores and stock must be conducted.

- **Assistance:** The assistance of the Assistant Postmaster-General, the Assistant Director in charge of the Stock Depot, and Inspectors attached to the Circle Office may be utilized if necessary.

Rule 2-A: Inspection of Circle Office

The Head of a Circle shall inspect their own office **once a year** and submit the Inspection Report to the Director General, Posts.

Rule 3: Visits to Offices and Mail Lines

A Postmaster General should endeavor to visit every station that serves as the headquarters of a district at least **once in two years**.

Rule 5: Examination of Diaries

The Head of a Circle must personally examine the diaries of Superintendents (Form Genl-1). This duty may also be delegated to the Director Postal Services (DPS).

Rule 8: Inspection of Returned Letter Offices (RLO)

The Head of the Circle or Director Postal Services must inspect the Returned Letter Office in their circle **once every year**, in accordance with the standard questions prescribed for such inspections.

Rule 10: Verification of Balances (Presidency Postmasters)

The balances of Mumbai, Kolkata, and Delhi GPO should be verified **two times a year** in accordance with standard questions.

Rule 20: Inspection of Superintendent's Office

The office of every Superintendent of Post Offices and R.M.S. will be thoroughly inspected at least **once in every 12 months**. While the Head of the Circle may undertake such inspections as desired, the inspection of remaining offices may be delegated to the Directors of Postal Services.

Rule 21: Inspection of Subordinate Offices and Sections

- **Head Post Offices (HPO/GPO):** Must be inspected **once in every 12 months** by the Senior Superintendents of Post Offices (SSPOs) having jurisdiction.
- **Verification of Balances:** The balances of every Head Office must be verified **twice in every 12 months** by the Superintendent, assisted by an Inspector. One of these verifications for second-class Head Offices is conducted during the annual inspection.
- **Mail/Record Offices:** Every mail office, record office, or section in a division must be thoroughly inspected **once in every 12 months**.
- **Presidency Offices:** The administrative branch is inspected by the Postmaster-General or the Director in charge of City areas. The actual inspection of various GPO branches is carried out by the Presidency Postmaster **twice a year**.

Rule 28: Monthly Statistics

The Head of a Circle must submit a statement in form **[Ms.-14(c)]** to the Director General every month.

- **Content:** Statistics of ordinary registered, insured, and value-payable articles (letter and parcel mail).

- **Compilation:** Compiled from the statistical memorandum [Ms. 14(a)] received from Head Offices and Mail Offices.
- **Deadline:** Must reach the Director-General not later than the **20th of the month** following the period to which the figures relate.

Rule 36: Memorandum of Authorised Balances and Advances

The Head of the Circle will supply each Presidency Post Office with a memo in form **Pa14**.

- **Scope:** Specifies the authorised minimum and maximum cash balances and the maximum balance for stamps.
- **Stamp Balances:** A Postmaster must keep a supply of ordinary stamps sufficient for the probable demands of **one week**. Therefore, the maximum limit should equal **one week's demand** plus the demand for the period between two supplies.

Rule 40: Objection Statements

In cases of loss arising through fraud, robbery, or accident, the Head of the Circle must pass early orders to adjust the amount without delay.

- **Settlement Timeline:** The matter should be settled within **three months**, either by recovery from the persons at fault or by requesting the Director-General to write off the amount.

Rule 49-A: Verification of Money Orders (MOs)

The percentage of Money Orders to be verified is fixed as follows:

- **Inspector of Post Offices (IPO):** Must verify payment of at least **25 money orders** in a month.
- **Others (T.I., Overseer):** Must verify payment of **50 money orders** per month.

Rule 54/1 & 55/1: Indian Postal Orders (IPOs) - Loss and Refund

- **Certificate of Non-Payment:** Can be obtained from the Deputy Accountant-General (Posts & Telegraphs) only after the expiry of **sixteen months** from the last day of the month of issue.
- **Refund Sanction:** The Superintendent or First-Class Postmaster may sanction the refund upon receipt of the non-payment certificate if the claim is genuine.
- **Refunds to Officials:** The Head of a Circle may sanction refunds to officials for lost IPOs, but not until **one full year** has elapsed since the date of loss, and only after ascertaining non-payment.

Rule 75: Prepayment of Postage in Cash

This facility is available for unregistered packets when the quantity is **not less than 500**.

Rule 76 & 77: Returned Letter Office (RLO) Returns

- **Enumeration:** An enumeration of ordinary unregistered articles (letter and parcel mail) is conducted during the **second week of February and August** each year.
- **Half-Yearly Return:** Form **RLO-5** is submitted for the six-month periods ending **30th September and 31st March**.
- **Submission Deadline:** Submitted by the Head of Circle to the DG Posts no later than **15th October and 15th April** respectively.

Rule 98: Trial Cards

Trial cards [M-26(a)] are service postcards used to determine the relative advantages of alternative mail routes or causes of detention. They must be returned with all entries filled in a service cover to the issuing officer.

Rule 102: Control over 1st Class Head Offices

The SSPOs must inspect all branches, including the administrative branch, **once a year**. Additionally, the accounts of the head office must be verified **twice every 12 months** at intervals of about **6 months**.

Rule 112: Distribution of Pay and Allowances

On the **5th of each month**, Head Offices must forward the Memorandum of Distribution of Pay and Allowances (**ACG-26**) for the preceding month, accompanied by A-Rolls, to the Superintendent/Sr. Superintendent.

Rule 117: Hours of Business Notices

The Superintendent must supply notices regarding hours of business as follows:

- **Form M-12:** Shows hours for delivery and despatch of mails (supplied to HOs and important SOs).
- **Form M-6(a):** Large notice for public business hours in English and local language (supplied to HOs and important SOs).
- **Form M-6:** Single notice for less important sub-offices.
- **Form M-6(c):** Prepared by the Inspector for branch offices in their jurisdiction.
- **Mail Offices:** Notices displaying despatch hours and public transaction hours must be displayed on a painted board.

Rule 122: Distribution of Work

Every Head Postmaster and Sub Postmaster assisted by one or more clerks must submit a memorandum of distribution of work in **Form MS-11** for the Superintendent's approval.

Rule 132: Beats of Village Postman

Inspectors must submit route lists and beat maps (**M-53**) to the Superintendent, indicating the introduction or discontinuance of mail exchanges in their sub-division.

Rule 134: Village Returns

The yearly village return (**MS-88**) must be carefully studied to determine if the work justifies the post or if it can be replaced by an Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM). Letter boxes cleared on holidays are denoted by "P.H.".

Rule 136: Sub Office Accounts

Monthly copies of sub-office accounts [**Pa.-17(a)**] are scrutinized by the Superintendent to check for unnecessary cash retention or remittance. Sub-offices need only submit an explanation in form **P.a.-20** when cash balances exceed authorized limits.

Rule 139: Maximum Cash Balance Principle

The difference between the maximum and minimum cash balance must in no case be **less than half the minimum** cash balance.

Rule 143 & 144: Memos of Authorized Balances

- **Sub Offices:** Supplied with Memo in form **Pa.14** or **Pa.14(s)**.
- **Branch Offices:** Supplied with Memo in form **Pa.-14(s)**.
- **Consolidated Memo:** The Superintendent supplies each Head Office with **Form Pa-15(s)**, showing authorized balances (cash, stamps, IPOs) and drawing limits for all sub-offices in account with that Head Office.

Rule 162: A (Sorting Order) & B (Guidance Order)

- **A Order:** When the Superintendent orders any change in a sorting list, instructions must be issued in the form of an "**A**" **Order**. A copy of every A order must be furnished to the Head of the Circle.

- **B Order:** Instructions on other subjects for the guidance of subordinates should be issued in the form of a "B" Order. A copy of B Orders is **not** furnished to the Head of Circle.
- **Camp Articles:** The letter 'T' should be prefixed to the letter 'B' for B Orders issued in connection with the disposal of Camp Articles for high officials on tour; these should be given a separate serial number.

Rule 164: Examination of Inspector's Diaries

- **Superintendent RMS:** Will receive a copy of each sub-divisional Inspector's diary [Genl-2(S)] weekly (on the **1st, 8th, 16th, and 24th**) and a monthly summary of work [Inspn-9] attached to the last diary of the month.
- **Superintendent of Post Offices:** Will receive a copy of each sub-divisional Inspector's diary [Genl-2] fortnightly (on the **1st and 16th**) and a monthly summary of work [Inspn-3] attached to the last diary of the month.

Rule 167: Inspection of Inspector's Office

The office of every Inspector should be thoroughly inspected by the Superintendent at least **once in every 12 months**. Upon completion, a copy of the remarks recorded in the order book (**Ms-8**) must be forwarded to the Head of the Circle.

Rule 168: Duties of Overseers

Overseers are employed in each division for:

- Supervision of runner's lines.
- Supervision of Village Postmen/Postmen/ABPMs serving in villages.
- Conveyance or escort of cash remittances from one office to another (when prescribed by the Head of the Circle).

Rule 169: Overseer Beat

- **Intervals:** The overseer is required to return to their central office regularly at fixed intervals, ordinarily not longer than **7 days**.
- **Route Statement:** The Superintendent must prepare a route statement for each overseer in the division.

Rule 170: Statistical Memorandum

Each Sub-divisional Inspector is required to submit a yearly statistical memorandum [MS-14(b)] for all sorting sections and sorting mail offices in the sub-division.

Rule 172: Speed of Mails on Mail Lines

- **Letter Mail Runners:** The prescribed speed is **5 miles per hour**.
- **Parcel Mail Runners:** The prescribed speed is **3 miles per hour**.

Rule 184: Haulage and Weighment Statement

On or before **1st February** and **1st August** each year, the Superintendent should submit a statement [MS-60(a)] to the Head of Circle showing the regular accommodation provided on each railway in the division on **21st January** and **21st July** respectively.

Rule 186: Superintendent's Clerk

The Superintendent is **not** authorized to take a clerk (except a steno-typist) on tour unless sanction is first obtained from the Head of Circle.

Rule 194/2: Register of Loss/Fraud

A register in form **M-89** should be maintained by the Superintendent to show a continuous record of cases occurring in their jurisdiction. The retention period is **7 years** for sections and **4 years** in the case of RMS.

Rule 195: Superintendent's Diary

- **Content:** Details of inspections and important matters for which separate reports are sent to the Head of Circle should **not** be recorded in the diary.
- **Submission:** The diary [Gen.1] is kept in a book. A copy of entries for the preceding fortnight should be sent to the Head of Circle on the **1st** and **16th** of each month.
- **First Class Postmasters:** Do not submit diaries but must submit a **quarterly statement** of inspection of various departments to the SSPOs.

Rule 202: Inspection of Superintendent's Office

- **Postal Superintendent:** Must thoroughly inspect their own office at least **once in every 12 months**.
- **RMS Superintendent:** Must carry out a similar inspection of the Head Record Office at least **once in every 12 months**.

Rule 212/1: Duplicate Keys

- **Authorization:** When an original key is lost, the issue of a duplicate key must be authorized by the Superintendent. Necessary entries must be made in the register by the Stock Clerk and attested by the Superintendent.
- **Transmission:** The duplicate key should be sent by parcel post, registered and insured for **Rs. 100**.

Rule 216: Painting of Letter Boxes and Safes

- **Letter Boxes:** The Superintendent must arrange for every letter box in the division to be regularly painted **once a year**.
- **Iron Safes:** Should be painted when necessary—**green outside** and **red inside**—to prevent rusting.

Rule 231: Test on Clearance of Letter Boxes

The Superintendent should frequently test the punctual clearance of letter boxes by posting Test Letters (M-29) or Test Postcards (M-26) addressed to themselves.

Rule 238: Inspection Standards and Frequency

There will be one verification and one verification-cum-inspection during the year.

- **First Half:** Verification.
- **Second Half:** Verification-cum-Inspection.

Standard Schedule for Inspection

S.No.	Office Category	Frequency	Duration (Days)
1	Head Post Office/GPO	Annual Inspection cum Verification	6 days
2	Head Post Office/GPO	Half Yearly Verification	3 days
3	Sub Post Office (HSG I & II) & MDG	Annual Inspection	3 days
4	Sub Post Office (LSG)	Annual Inspection	2 days
5	A Class (1+2 handed) Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	2 days
6	A Class (1+2 handed) Non-Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	2 days
7	B Class (Double Handed) Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	2 days
8	B Class (Double Handed) Non-Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	2 days
9	C Class (Single Handed) Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	2 days
10	C Class (Single Handed) Non-Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	1 day

11	Non-Delivery Sub Post Office (Single Handed)	Annual Inspection	1 day
12	Branch Post Office	Annual Inspection	1 day
13	Head Record Office	Annual Inspection	3 days
14	Sub Record Office (HSG & LSG)	Annual Inspection	2 days
15	Sub Record Office (Time Scale)	Annual Inspection	2 days
16	PSD (Postal Store Depot)	Annual Inspection	4 days
17	Circle/Regional Office	Annual Inspection	3 days
18	Division Office	Annual Inspection	3 days
19	Sub Division Office	Annual Inspection	1 day
20	RAKNPA/PTC	Annual Inspection	3 days
21	O/o SE Civil, Electric/Sr. Architect	Annual Inspection	3 days
22	RLO (Returned Letter Office)	Annual Inspection	1 day
23	O/o Manager MMS	Annual Inspection	1 day
24	Mail Office (TMO, NSH, ICH, PH etc)	Annual Inspection	1 day
25	O/o DAP. GM (Finance)	Annual Inspection	3 days
26	Foreign Post Office	Annual Inspection	2 days
27	SBCO by AO (ICO, SB)	Annual Inspection	4 days (3 for HPOs + 1 for SOs)
28	Business Post Office	Half Yearly Inspection	2 days

Time Schedule for Inspection Completion

- 1st Quarter (Jan - Mar): 15%
- 2nd Quarter (Apr - Jun): 35%
- 3rd Quarter (Jul - Sep): 30%
- 4th Quarter (Oct - Dec): 20%

Rule 239: Verification of Balances of Head Office

The Superintendent must thoroughly and completely verify the balances of all Head Offices within the division **twice in every 12 months** at intervals of about **6 months**.

Mandatory Verification Checks

Check	Frequency/Sample Size
HO Summary (ACG-1)	Check entries for 4 dates of different months.
Treasurer Cash Book (ACG-2)	Check at least 4 dates in different months.
Register of Cheques	Check at least 4 dates in different months.
SO Summary vs. Daily Account	Select at least 4 dates at random since last verification.
BO Summary vs. Daily Account	Select at least 4 dates at random since last verification.
Service Books	Check at least 5% of books taken randomly.

Issue of Inspection Reports (Timeline)

Duration of Inspection	Deadline for Issuing Report
1 Day	15 Days
2 Days to < 8 Days	30 Days
8 Days and above	45 Days

Rule 261: Powers of Inspector

- **Appointing Authority:** The Inspector is the appointing authority for Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS) other than the GDS BPM.
- **Leave Sanction:** Can grant leave for GDS BPMs for a period not exceeding **60 days** and for other GDS up to **90 days** at a stretch.

Rule 273: Beats of Village Postmen/ABPM

- **Route Lists:** The Inspector must prepare and prescribe route lists and beat maps (M-53) indicating the beats of Village Postmen attached to each Branch Office.
- **Distribution:** Copies are sent to the respective office, the Superintendent, and the Account Office.
- **Systems:** Beats can be arranged as (a) **Fixed Beat** or (b) **Unfixed Beat**.

Rule 276: Village Sorting Lists

The Inspector should supply a Village Sorting List (M-52) showing:

- The number of Village Postmen to whom articles are made over.
- The names of villages served by each Village Postman and subordinate office (alphabetical order).
- Location of letter boxes and identification of those with changeable plates.

Rule 277: Village Return

- **Submission:** Submitted by each Branch Office in **March** every year.
- **Duration:** Kept for the **first 14 days of March**, showing daily receipt of articles (including Money Orders) for delivery.
- **Review:** The Inspector examines these returns and forwards them to the Superintendent with remarks.
- **Deadline:** Must reach the Superintendent not later than **1st April**.

Rule 280: Letter Box Locks

The Inspector should carry **half a dozen Aligarh locks** (standard size) while on tour to replace any unserviceable locks immediately.

Rule 282: Mail Overseer's Diaries

- **Submission:** The Inspector receives weekly diaries (**Genl-4**), a work summary (**Genl-12**), and a monthly list of Money Orders verified (**Genl-6**) from Overseers.
- **Processing:** The monthly list of verified MOs is submitted to the Superintendent along with the Inspector's summary by the **8th of the month**.

Rule 293: Inspector's Diaries

- **Inspector RMS:** Submits diary [**Genl-2(S)**] weekly (1st, 8th, 16th, 24th).
- **Inspector Posts:** Submits diary [**Genl-2**] fortnightly (1st and 16th).
- **MO Verification:** Must verify payment of at least **25 Money Orders** per month.

Rule 295 & 296: Circulars

- **DG Circulars:** Issued by the Director General **once a week**.
- **HOC Circulars:** Issued by the Head of Circle **once a month**.
- **Filing:** CPMG circulars should be filed in a single guard book, distinct from DG circulars.

Rule 298: Order Book

The Inspector will maintain an order book in form **MS-8**. Each book contains **200 serially numbered pages**.

Rule 299: Verification of Balances (Inspector)

The Inspector must thoroughly verify the balances of all Head Post Offices within their sub-division **two times in every 12 months**.

Rule 300: Inspection of Post Offices

The Inspector must inspect:

- Sub-offices assigned by the Superintendent **once every 12 months**.
- All Branch Offices (except those inspected by the Superintendent).

Rule 357: Stock Depot Manager

The official in charge of a Stock Depot in Postal Circles is designated as **Manager**.

Rule 369-A: Black Stamp Cancellation Ink

Superior quality black stamp cancellation ink is exclusively procured from **M/s Mysore Lac and Paint Works Ltd., Mysore** by the Superintendent, PSD Bangalore.

Rule 374: Disposal of Returned Articles

Obsolete and unserviceable stamps and seals must **never be sold**. They must be sent to the **Postal Workshop at Aligarh** for disposal.

Rule 380: Despatch of Stock Articles

- **Over 10 Kgs:** Sent by rail, steamer, or other conveyance.
- **Under 10 Kgs:** Sent by **Service Registered Parcel** if containing valuables.

Rule 381: Despatch of Forms

- **Small Quantities:** Despatched as Service Packets.
- **Over 5 Kg:** Enclosed in a bag and sent as goods by rail/steamer.

Rule 406: Lottery Tickets (RLO)

Lottery tickets detected in transmission will be **destroyed** under the personal supervision of an officer not below the rank of **Director**.

Rule 414: Compulsory Insurance

If an insured article is found to contain items requiring compulsory insurance, a special fee of **Rs. 2/-** is taxed by the delivery office and is recoverable from the addressee upon redirection by the RLO.

Rule 433: Disposal of Unregistered RLO Articles

- **Letters/Postcards:** Destroyed by **shredding** in the presence of the Manager.
- **Book Packets (No Value):** Sold as waste paper or destroyed.
- **Magazines:** Unclaimed copies are returned to publishers/distributors.

Rule 434: Disposal of Registered/Valuable RLO Articles

Undelivered items are detained at the Returned Letter Office (RLO) for:

- **15 days** (if unaccountable).
- **30 days** (if accountable).

Disposal Methods:

- **No Intrinsic Value:** Sold as waste paper or destroyed.
- **Magazines/Newspapers:** May be used for public purpose (Regional Head's option).
- **Intrinsic Value:** Disposed of through **auction**.
- **Unpaid Postcards/Letter Cards:** Destroyed forthwith.

Minimum Visits by Senior Functionaries

S.No.	Designation	Office Category	Visits per Month
1	CPMG / PMG / DPS / Div. Head	HO / GPO	1
		SO	1
		BO	1
		Mail Office	1
2	SSRM / SRM	Mail Office (NSH/ICH/PH/TMO etc.)	3 (at least 2 night visits)
		Delivery Post Office	1

Note: Visit remarks must be issued by the **next working day** and reviewed by the competent authority within a **fortnight**.